

Chapter 55 - Correct

The next morning, the Yan family's driver arrived punctually at the hospital entrance, and waiting outside was also Wen Zhen's car.

Before long, Feng Yue appeared at the entrance wrapped up tightly, followed by Yan Lin wearing a cervical traction device and Mother Yan carrying bags.

Wen Zhen saw the group of three through the windshield, then reached out to pick up the bouquet of carnations from her passenger seat and opened the car door.

Wen Zhen had visited Yan Lin during her stay, but at that time Yan Lin's memory was confused, so she hadn't shown much hostility toward her.

But now it was different. Yan Lin's aftereffects had healed, so the moment she saw Wen Zhen, her expression instantly darkened.

"Miss Yan, congratulations on your recovery." Wen Zhen smiled as she handed the bouquet of carnations to Yan Lin.

Yan Lin knew she had to accept this bouquet, so she smiled coldly. "Thank you, Boss Wen, for specially coming to welcome my discharge in such cold weather."

Mother Yan had also become quite familiar with Wen Zhen during this period. Wen Zhen was very skilled at handling people, and Mother Yan was indeed completely won over by her.

"Xiao Zhen, you came too." Mother Yan warmly invited her. "Come to Auntie's house for dinner today. You and Xiao Yue come together. We're just having a homecoming feast for Ah Lin."

Feng Yue and Wen Zhen exchanged glances, then nodded in agreement.

Yan Lin watched their interaction and found it irritating. Fortunately, it was cold outside, so everyone quickly got into their cars. However, after getting in the car, Yan Lin felt even more frustrated.

Because Feng Yue had gotten into Wen Zhen's car.

Yan Lin was furious inside but showed nothing on her face. However, Mother Yan knew her well—when she saw Yan Lin gripping the flower wrapping paper tightly, she knew her emotions were poor.

The Yan family's car drove smoothly on the road. Mother Yan waited for Yan Lin to calm down a bit before speaking. "Ah Lin."

Yan Lin turned her head. "Mm."

"Are you still planning to win Xiao Yue back?"

Yan Lin didn't know why her mother suddenly asked this, but still nodded. "Mm, I want to win her back."

"Do you still remember what I asked you when you two got engaged?" Mother Yan turned to look at her, her gaze focused and serious.

This question felt quite distant to the current Yan Lin. In her mother's eyes, her engagement to Feng Yue might have been over a year ago, but for her, this matter had already passed four to almost five years.

Yan Lin carefully recalled, thought for a moment, then said, "I remember. You asked if I liked her."

Mother Yan nodded and turned to look out the car window. "When we learned about your engagement, your father and I weren't surprised, just a bit worried. That's why I asked you that question."

"Now, it's the same. I still ask you this question: Do you really like Xiao Yue? Or is it just because you're not used to having no one around? If you just hope someone can care for and take care of you like Xiao Yue used to, then I hope you won't disturb her anymore. Xiao Zhen is a good choice for Xiao Yue." Mother Yan looked at Yan Lin, but the words she spoke were ones Yan Lin didn't want to hear.

Yan Lin looked at her mother, her gaze firm and bright. "I like her. I like Feng Yue. I will win her back and won't give her up to anyone."

Mother Yan looked at Yan Lin with shock. She could feel the aggression and strong possessiveness emanating from her child.

Mother Yan frowned and looked at Yan Lin with displeasure. "If you really liked her, you wouldn't say such things. Didn't Xiao Yue teach you what correct love is in twelve years?"

Yan Lin was stunned and didn't understand what her mother meant.

Correct love?

What did that mean?

Yan Lin opened her mouth, wanting to ask her mother what this meant, but at this moment the car had already stopped in the courtyard of the old mansion.

Everyone got out of the car. Aunt Yang was waiting in the courtyard with several servants. Some held basins and clean towels in their hands, while Aunt Yang held several leaves of an unidentifiable variety.

"Miss, come, come, wash your hands with water boiled with pomelo¹ leaves." Aunt Yang took those pomelo leaves and began patting them around Yan Lin.

"Aunt Yang, what is this for?" Yan Lin was somewhat confused.

"Pomelo leaves dispel bad luck! You and Madam... Miss Feng have had bad luck, quickly come wash." Aunt Yang spoke quickly and almost called Feng Yue "Madam" again.

Wen Zhen and Feng Yue had just gotten out of the car when they saw the Yan family's servants approaching them with a basin of water.

The servants in the Yan family's old mansion were also quite familiar with Feng Yue, after all, she had once been the mistress here.

"Miss Feng, this is water boiled with pomelo leaves. Come wash your hands quickly, and later we'll have Aunt Yang pat your body with pomelo leaves too."

Feng Yue didn't understand what this was about, so she turned to look at Mother Yan standing nearby.

Mother Yan smiled and said, "Go ahead and wash. I had Aunt Yang prepare this. Better to believe it exists than not²."

Feng Yue didn't want to disappoint the elder's good intentions, so she had to go through the whole process.

After they entered the house, the dining table was already filled with various dishes. It truly was a proper homecoming feast.

Father Yan wasn't home because he had to go to the company to handle important matters, so only four people sat around the dining table.

During the meal, Mother Yan single-handedly kept the atmosphere lively, chatting about this and that with the three younger people.

Originally, Yan Lin wanted to talk more with Feng Yue, but her mind was still preoccupied with what her mother had said in the car.

Those words left her thoroughly confused.

She was someone who never questioned her own decisions. Whatever she wanted to do, once she did it, even if the result was failure, she never regretted it or had thoughts like "it would have been better if I hadn't done it."

But what if something was wrong from the beginning?

Yan Lin was puzzled, and her confusion continued until after dinner that evening.

Feng Yue and Wen Zhen didn't stay for dinner but left after sitting for a while following lunch.

Yan Lin had thought about asking them to stay, but her mother gave her no opportunity to speak. So Feng Yue left with Wen Zhen just like that.

After dinner, Yan Lin returned to her room. She was now sitting upright at her desk, with an open laptop in front of her showing a long string of browser search history.

"What is correct love?"

"What love is correct?"

"Why is my love incorrect?"

Such search records hung in a long string below the browser's search box.

Looking at those irrelevant results and the endless pop-up ads, Yan Lin felt the urge to clean up the internet for the first time.

At this moment, her room door was knocked.

"Come in."

Mother Yan pushed open the door, holding a thick photo album in her hands. "You're not asleep yet?"

Yan Lin shook her head. "Mom, why did you come?"

"Didn't you have something to ask me in the car today? I came to answer your questions." Mother Yan placed the photo album with obviously yellowed edges on Yan Lin's desk, then sat on the bed.

"What is this?"

Mother Yan smiled mysteriously. "I'll show you later."

Hearing this, Yan Lin didn't get too curious and instead thought about how to ask about these matters.

Mother Yan didn't rush her, just quietly waited for her to speak.

After a while, Yan Lin finally asked, "Mom, I don't know what you meant by what you said in the car. What do you mean by 'correct love'? Isn't love just love? Can there be incorrect love?"

Yan Lin had been quite slow when it came to emotional matters since childhood. Even though she now knew that her feelings for Feng Yue were liking, were love, she still didn't understand that love and possessiveness were different things.

Mother Yan didn't immediately answer her question but reached out to open the photo album.

On the first page of the album, there was only one photo. It was a candid shot of Yan Lin and Feng Yue performing at their school evening gala.

The background was their school's auditorium, and on stage were only the two of them plus a pure white grand piano on a stand.

Two spotlights shone down from above. Yan Lin's long, seaweed-like curls gleamed under the lights, and the light blue chiffon dress she wore elevated her to an unreachable position, like a snow lotus blooming on Tianshan Mountain³.

Under the other spotlight, Feng Yue had her long hair completely pinned back, and the pure black fitted ballet outfit perfectly showcased her slender, graceful waist, looking exactly like the little ballet dancer in a music box.

Feng Yue's family also had an identical copy of this photo.

Yan Lin naturally remembered this photo. This was the opportunity for her and Feng Yue to meet, the beginning of the two of them. However, she still didn't understand her mother's intention in showing her this photo.

Mother Yan saw Yan Lin's confused expression and smiled slightly. "Do you think this Xiao Yue looks beautiful?"

Yan Lin nodded as a matter of course.

"What about this one?" Mother Yan turned to the next page, which showed Feng Yue's graduation photo from middle school. Standing in the sunlight, Feng Yue was showing a brilliant smile, as radiant as the sunshine that day.

Yan Lin nodded again. She didn't know her mother had actually collected solo photos of Feng Yue.

Mother Yan continued flipping through several more pages, all photos Yan Lin had never seen before. There were naturally some of her as well, but obviously there were more of Feng Yue.

"So, do you prefer this Xiao Yue, or do you prefer the Xiao Yue from that day when you bullied her until she fainted and was dying and had to be hospitalized?" Mother Yan looked seriously into Yan Lin's eyes.

Yan Lin froze in place, her mind recalling everything that had happened that night at Feng Yue's door.

She also felt that she had done wrong that night, but deep down she felt it was just an accident after getting drunk.

She believed that when sober, she would never cause such consequences, which is why she later went to Feng Yue's house to apologize.

"Do you think that was just an accident?" Mother Yan asked.

Yan Lin didn't speak, but Mother Yan clearly saw the evasion in her eyes.

"Was it really an accident?" Mother Yan said. "Really not a case of alcohol giving courage to the cowardly⁴, of speaking true feelings when drunk?"

Yan Lin's fingertips went cold, her gaze staring blankly at her mother.

"Ah Lin, that wasn't an accident. From the day you moved into Songhe Bay⁵, this incident was bound to happen between you two."

"You know this yourself, don't you?"

Mother Yan's gentle inquiry sent tremors through Yan Lin's entire body.

Did she know?

She knew...

Footnotes:

1. **Pomelo** (柚子) - A large citrus fruit popular in Chinese culture. Pomelo leaves are traditionally used in Chinese folk practices to ward off bad luck and negative energy.
2. **"Better to believe it exists than not"** (宁可信其有不可信其无) - A common Chinese saying expressing the philosophy of being cautious about superstitions—it's better to be safe than sorry.
3. **Tianshan Mountain** (天山) - A major mountain range in Central Asia, known for its snow-capped peaks. In Chinese literature, it's often used as a metaphor for something pure, remote, and beautiful.
4. **"Alcohol giving courage to the cowardly"** (酒壮怂人胆) - A Chinese idiom meaning that alcohol can make timid people bold, often leading them to do things they wouldn't normally do.
5. **Songhe Bay** (颂和湾) - The name of the residential area where Yan Lin moved to live closer to Feng Yue. "Songhe" literally means "praise and harmony."